

Change Management and Disaster Recovery Document for Soundbite.AI

This document outlines the change management process and disaster recovery practices for Soundbite.AI. These policies and procedures have been approved by management to ensure compliance with industry standards and to maintain operational reliability and security. This document specifically addresses the management of changes to infrastructure, applications, and services, as well as the geographic separation of backup data.

Change Management Policy

Purpose: The change management process ensures that changes to infrastructure, applications, and services are systematically proposed, reviewed, approved, and implemented to minimize disruption and risk to the production environment. This policy applies to all changes made to:

- Infrastructure (e.g., servers, networks, storage).
- Applications (e.g., source code, configurations).
- Services (e.g., APIs, integrations).

Tools and Systems

Our change management process leverages Azure DevOps to manage documentation, work items, version control, and continuous delivery pipelines. Key components include:

- **Change Requests:** Work items are tracked as user stories or bugs in Azure DevOps. All changes must be tied back to one or more work items, creating an audit trail of who requested the change, what the request was, and a timeline of its lifecycle.
- **Version Control:** Git repositories managed within Azure DevOps.
- **Pull Request Workflow:** All changes are subject to code review and automated testing before merging into the trunk branch.
- **Continuous Deployment:** Automated build, test, and deploy steps are triggered post-merge to Trunk. No direct developer access to Trunk is allowed. No direct deployments from developer machine to preview or production is allowed.

Approval Flow

Changes proposed through pull requests must pass compilation and automated tests through Developer Sandbox, Preview for Final QA, and Production environments:

- **Developer Sandbox:** Automated deployment on PR approval
- **Preview:** Manual approval following QA validation which activates automated deployment to Preview
- **Production:** Final manual approval after successful validation in Preview activates automated deployment to Production

- **Emergency Changes:** Emergency changes are processed through the same deployment pipeline, ensuring all changes adhere to the standard testing and approval workflow, maintaining consistency and reliability.

Disaster Recovery Practices

Our disaster recovery (DR) plan ensures the continued availability and integrity of production data and services in the event of an incident. DR measures include database replication, point-in-time restore backups, and geographically redundant storage.

Database Backups:

- Databases are replicated to a secondary region in Azure for high availability.
- Point-in-time restore capabilities allow for recovery of specific snapshots of data.

Azure Storage:

- Azure Storage uses Geo-Redundant Storage (GRS) settings to maintain copies in three separate regions.

Testing and Validation:

- Backup restoration processes are tested periodically to ensure data integrity and recovery reliability.
- Replication processes are monitored continuously, with alerts configured for failures.

Geographic Separation:

- Backup data is stored in locations separate from the primary production region.
- These regions are selected to ensure resilience against localized outages or disasters.

Monitoring and Review

Post-Change Monitoring:

- All deployments are monitored for performance, errors, and security anomalies.
- Automated alerts notify the team of any issues post-deployment.

Review Process:

- Periodic reviews of the change management process ensure it meets evolving business and security requirements.
- Disaster recovery plans are updated annually and after major infrastructure changes.

Documentation and Compliance

Change Logs:

- All changes are logged within Azure DevOps for audit and compliance purposes, including traceability from work item to PR to deployments through environments.

Policy Updates:

- This document is reviewed bi-annually or as needed to align with changes in infrastructure, applications, or services.

Conclusion

The outlined change management and disaster recovery practices demonstrate a commitment to maintaining secure, reliable, and compliant operations. These processes provide a robust framework for managing changes and ensuring business continuity.